

Tell us how you're feeling!



Welcome to CC@R Education!!!

Education Session #1



Welcome to CC@R Education
Creating Your “Recipe” for Success

1. MBA2 Panel
2. What is **CC@R Education**?
 - MBA2's who recruited last year sharing our experiences about how we achieved recruiting success (& struggled along the way...)
 - Our goals for you
 - Meet the Team
3. Consulting Hiring Criteria Review
4. Preview of the Ed Session curriculum & expectations
5. Recruiting Timeline & Events
6. Practice Coffee Chats
7. What you can be working on now
8. Questions

Note from the Ed Team - *We are an open book, please give us feedback along the way!*



- You already have the tools to succeed
 - You are here for a reason!
 - You have a strong support system - CDO, Peer Coaches, CCR, and most importantly, your classmates in this room!
- We want to these sessions to be transparent and honest. We will only be sending recordings for valid reasons (would you email this request to your professor?)
- These sessions will be very interactive, and skills-based. Today's session will be lecture heavy
- ED sessions are just 1 hour a week – focus on building on the learnings in FACT groups and through your own practice
 - Consulting Recruitment is not easy but work on what you can control!
- What works for someone else might not work for you! Be true to yourself
- Be mindful of your own time but also other's time - be engaged, participate

*We are a community that **supports and champions** one another through the **highs and lows** that come with recruiting for consulting.*

*We treat each other with **respect, value truth, and share advice** to help one another succeed.*

Who can I reach out to for help?

- CC@R Education Team

- Smarak Dash Bhattamishra (smarakdb@umich.edu), SVP of Education, PC
- Ashley Grossman (ashleysg@umich.edu), VP of Education, PC
- Aman Bedi (amanbedi@umich.edu), VP of Education, PC
- Sumit Modi (sumitnm@umich.edu), VP of Case Book
- Jordan Black (blackjn@umich.edu), Co-President, PC, FACT Group VP
- Morgan Manchester (mmanch@umich.edu), Co- President

- CDO Peer Coaches/ FACT Group Leaders

- Randy Albert

Any MBA2; we're here to help!

MBA2 Panel

Meet your panelists!



Gursharan Bains



Pavel Dounaevski



Drashti Thakrar



Ben Lopez



Megha Aggarwal



Amitoj Singh



Involvement: CC@R SVP of Education & Peer Coach

Prior Industry: CPG and Retail sales and strategy

[illegible]

Recruiting Perspective

Pro-Tip: Don't get stuck in the weeds for too long, think of the big picture!

Low point: Mock case - tried to impress the interviewer with math skills, ended up going so deep into one exhibit that could not complete the case

Outlet: Weightlifting, board games, ranting to SO



Ashley Grossman

Involvement: CC@R VP of Education & Peer Coach

Internship: PwC, San Francisco

Prior Industry: Professional Water Polo

Recruiting:
A Visual Essay



Recruiting
Perspective

Pro-Tip: Get comfortable being uncomfortable / learn to act cool, calm, & collected even if you're freaking out inside

Low point: Getting rejected from a firm where I really pictured myself and got along with the people super well...in the end, I believe things happen as they are meant to

Outlet: Working out, wine nights with friends, meditation & family phone calls

Meet the Team



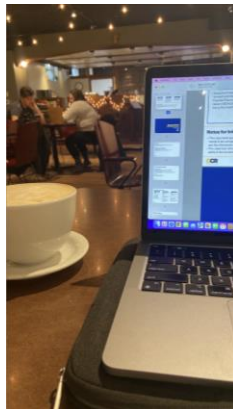
Aman Bedi

Involvement: CC@R VP of Education, & Peer Coach

Internship: Bain & Company, Washington DC

Prior Industry: Strategy & Ops; Supply Chain Ops (Auto)

Recruiting: A Visual Essay



MON 19	TUE 20	WED 21	THU 22	FRI 23	SAT 24
		Ben Lopez's Birthday			Christmas Eve
	Look into student loans 9 - 8pm	Missed Bellini - Research & Alan, Verdad, Alan C	Framework Skills + BCC Math 9:30 - 11am		
Study session + BCC	Early Commencement - Alan 8:45am, Verdad, Alan C	Q1 Data Research and edit		Aman Bedi's Zoom Meet Team, Morgan, Hannah, Ben	South / Aman Capa 10:15am, Morgan, Hannah, Ben
Aman Bedi Open, Morgan	Continue to	Student Ambassador 1		Section 8 Case Completed 11am - 1:15pm	
Virtual meet with Ross		Aman + Ben re: BCC Doc	Cheryl/Karen & Alan Meds 11:30am - 1:30pm		
	With Aman Bedi/Research Prep 12:30 - 2pm https://uconn.human.com	Q1 Data Research from	Aman Bedi's Zoom Meet Team, Morgan, Hannah, Ben		
Ben's Student Council with		Aman + Ben re: BCC Doc	Aman - South Mock Case 2:30 - 3pm https://uconn.human.com		
Class / Emma Loring 2:15 - 3:45pm	Dyn 3:30 - 5pm	Alan + Ben re: BCC Doc	Aman - South Mock Case 2:30pm, Morgan, Hannah, Ben		
	BCC Experience & Data 6 - 8pm	Late Shutdown and Maintenance 5:30 - 6:45pm	Dyn 5:45 - 8pm	Refined - Board Task 5 - 7:30pm	
		Alan + Ben re: Case 6:45 - 8:45pm		Classroom Review 5 - 6:30pm	
				Review LCR Interview 6 - 7pm	



Pro-Tip: Try to find some joy and happiness in the process - what you do to prepare (especially casing) will be a good representation of the work in consulting

Recruiting Perspective

Low point: Got 2 rejections and 1 waitlist call on the same night; could not find the energy to go out the whole weekend

Outlet: Soccer, support system at Ross and family back home



Jordan Black

Involvement: CC@R Co-President, Peer Coach, & FACT Group VP (Overachiever Beaver!)

Internship: Bain & Company, Boston

Prior Industry: Qualitrics>>>> Ever heard of it???

**Recruiting:
A Visual Essay**



Pro-Tip: Be cool as a cucumber, like me. Also find time to do things other than recruiting, like study...NOT. 😎

**Recruiting
Perspective**

Low point: I signed off Zoom before the second part of an interview like a dingbat! SO embarrassing omgee!!

Outlet: Costco samples, walking in my Hokas, watching American Fútbol, bantering, and Tik Tok dances (catch me at Rick's to see me perform live).

Our goal is to help you excel against the following hiring criteria

Could I put you on a project tomorrow?

Can you do the work?

Structured, Analytical,
and Creative Thinker /
Problem Solver

A Leader, Impactful,
History of
(Over)Achievement

Organized,
Strong Project Manager,
Team Player

Can I put you in front of clients?

Great Communicator - Written & Oral:
Clear and Concise with Tone
Appropriate to Situation

Strong Executive Presence,
Influential Beyond Span of Control

Seeks Challenges,
Handles Pressure

Would I enjoy working with you?

Positive, Can Do Attitude,
Coachable

Driven to Add Value

Interesting and Interested
(Airport Test)

These are the criteria used to evaluate your resume, fit interviews, casing and networking.

Recruiting Key Actions

Resume-building

Build out your resume in the ACR format, adhering to CDO guidelines and Randy's tip sheet, and get it reviewed by peer coaches and Randy

Networking

Often referred to as 'Coffee Chats', this is your opportunity to Interact with reps from across firms, with the aim to understand the culture and the work, and if you would want to work there

Preparation

Casing and behaviorals preparation. You learn the basics, and do reps with peer coaches, Randy and other MBA1s

Application

Final application is a mix of submission on Ross Recruit and company website. Cover letters may be required depending on the firm

Interview

Standard interview format is a mix of both casing and a behaviorals interview, typically in a power round

What are these Ed Sessions going to teach us?

Week	Date	Topic
1	September 10, 2023	Rules of the Game
2	September 17, 2023	Articulating Value: Resume & Odyssey & Behavioral
3	September 24, 2023	Getting into casing, Case workshop (Case Start)
4	October 1, 2023	Frameworks and Brainstorming (Case Start contd.), Exhibits & Math (Case Middle)
5	October 8, 2023	Recommendations (Case End)
6	October 15, 2023	FINALS
7	October 22 2023	FALL BREAK
8	October 29, 2023	Cover Letters / Application
9	November 5, 2023	Bringing It All Together
10	November 12, 2023	Weakness Weak
11	November 19, 2023	Behavioral Deep Dive
12	November 26, 2023	THANKSGIVING
13	December 3, 2023	Interview Real Talk

**This excludes any supplementary sessions*

Recruiting curriculum is aligned between CC@R & peer coaching to reinforce recruiting principles

Ed Sessions – “Lecture”

- 2-3 leaders to all MBA 1s
- General curriculum and guiding principles
- Coordinates with CDO in creating FACT group curriculum
- Supplementary sessions to reinforce and practice principles taught

FACT Groups – “Working Group”

- 1 leader to 8-10 MBA 1s
- Tailored guidance and group feedback
- Delivers curriculum

Peer Coaching – “Practice”

- 1:1 sessions, simulates actual interviews
- Available 10/2 on Ross Recruit (limit 2 per week)
- Individualized feedback

MBA 1s are strongly encouraged to attend all sessions

- Please follow up with fellow students or Peer Coaches if you are unable to attend

MBA 1s should work with other MBA 1s to practice concepts outside of sessions

- CC@R and FACT groups are only 2-3 hours of learning a week
- Working with each other is the best way to practice and make improvement on feedback you have already received

Recruiting Process Timeline

September	October	November	December	January
Understanding if consulting is right for you				
CC@R Sunday Sessions & FACT Groups				
	Corporate Presentations			
	Coffee Chats			
	Case Workshops			
	Case Competitions			
Application Prep				
Create / Edit Resume			Create / Prep Cover Letters	
	Interview Prep			
	Create / Practice Odyssey		Behavioral interview prep	
	Case Interview Preparation			
			First Resume Drop	Interviews

Networking First Principles from CDO

- **Networking is about getting to know each other.** Don't pitch yourself prematurely.
- **The primary objective of networking is thorough due diligence** – is the firm a good fit for YOU? (can also help shape your answers to “why consulting” and “why this firm”)
- Consulting firms want you to demonstrate you can use their collective time effectively, **so your goal is a few quality relationships.** Too many surface-level relationships will be seen as unproductive.
- Many coffee chats will be in a **group format** – please **be respectful of everyone in the group, not just the interviewer.** Let everyone ask a question before you ask your second question

Keep in mind: If a firm has one spot left on their closed list and two equally compelling resumes, one from a candidate they've met and liked, and one from a candidate they haven't met, the candidate they met and liked will get that last spot.

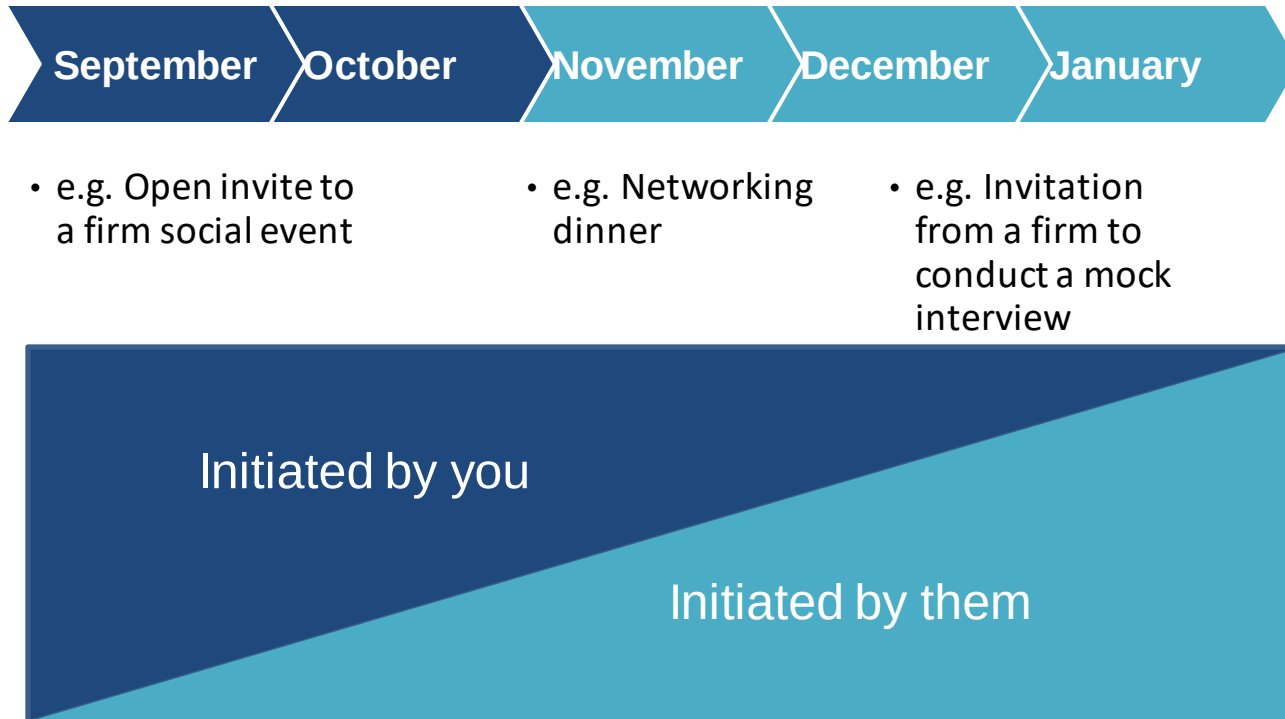
During Fall A and into Fall B, you will have various opportunities to meet with firms

	Event Description	General Starting Time	Open event/sign-up/ Invite only	To go/not to go
Coffee Chats/ Office Hours	One-on-one or group Q&A sessions with current consultants or recruiters	Mid-September onwards	Sign-up – usually first come, first serve	GO once or twice if you have a compelling reason
One-on-one "coffee" chats	30-minute conversation over zoom or in-person	Mid-September onwards	Open (you initiate by emailing a contact) or sign up via Ross Recruit	GO – if you have a purpose
Corporate Presentations	Major corporate event, including speakers and reception	Mid-September onwards	Open	GO – if you're available
Case Competitions	Business case competitions	October – December	Open	Optional – be mindful of time commitments, though they are great firm exposure
Case Workshops	Company sponsored case workshops	October – November	Some are open; others are closed	GO – if you're available
Mock Interviews	"Non-evaluative" interviews with current consultants	November-December	Invite only	GO – if you're available
Happy hours	"Non-evaluative" social event	October – November	Open	GO – if you're available
Meals	"Non-evaluative", smaller social events	October – November	Sign-up/Invite only	GO – if you're available

- Nothing in this table is set in stone. The nature of events and how people feel about them can vary
- If you have a conflict (e.g. - can't attend an event that you'd like to), communicate with the firm and use that as an opportunity to build rapport
- You may feel pressure to take advantage of every opportunity to interface with firms, however at the end of the day be thoughtful and only take part in activities that you feel are adding value to your process and help you build rapport
- **DO NOT**, we repeat **DO NOT** attend any **MBA2-only** events
- **"Non-evaluative"** events are **still somewhat evaluative** – don't do anything you wouldn't do in a professional setting

The types of interactions you will have with firms will change as the recruiting season progresses

Recruiting event progression timeline



Considerations

- As the recruiting season progresses, candidates will have **increasing opportunities to meet Consultants in smaller group settings**
- Smaller group interactions have their pros and cons – a lot can be gained from a more intimate setting **IF** you come prepared. Have an **objective and structure**
- Take **advantage of the opportunities initiated by firms at the beginning** – this will make the process of you initiating interactions more organic later
- When you start to initiate interactions, be sure you understand **WHY** you are reaching out before you do it
- **Don't worry** if you don't get invited to invite-only events – while nice, there are other ways to connect more deeply with a firm – and there is no correlation between invites and closed lists / offers

Do I have to go to all these events?



If you do **sign up** for an event...

Rule 1: YOU MUST GO!!

Rule 2: You have to dress well for these events – first impressions matter! Err on the more formal side of dressing (suits aren't necessary, but jeans are not acceptable)

NETWORKING EVENTS START SOON!

Successful networkers should:

- **Answer the question “Tell me about yourself” succinctly**
 - PREPARE YOUR ODYSSEY AND RESUME! (CC@R Education Week 2)
- **Know which firm you are talking to and “show up”**
 - DO YOUR RESEARCH & STAY ORGANIZED! (More to come later)
- **Know why you want to be a consultant**

What works...

- ✓ **Being yourself** – Don't feel the need to fake it until you make it. Imagine that you are connecting with your super nice ex-manager
- ✓ **Be flexible** – your interviewer might ask for your odyssey .
- ✓ **Aim to connect** – if you can do this, your coffee chat will be successful!
- ✓ **Learn!** – you want to know more about the firm and work, and if this is the right firm for you

...and what does not

- **Being boastful** and taking airtime – if you feel you have done good work, then be subtle about presenting them. Don't speak for 15 mins in a 20 min coffee chat
- **Not preparing** – take detailed notes and think about what you know about the firm already. DON'T GO IN BLIND!
- **Not dressing well** – aim to always be better dressed than the interviewer.

1. If you sign up for an event, **you must attend**. If you cannot attend, cancel within 24hrs.
2. **Do not no-show a coffee chat**. These slots are at a premium. The firms will remember.
3. When asking for time for a coffee chat, **suggest time slots**
4. Expect to have **camera on for all virtual events** - dress as if in-person (AKA look professional) and use the [Ross virtual background](#) or blur your background
5. If in person, lean towards **business professional** (collared shirt, blazer, nice pants – **no jeans**)
6. Send a **thank you note within 24** hours for all coffee chats - customize the note based on your conversation
7. Some events are **click races** and some are not – Firms will give you ample opportunities to interact with them, and **you can always reach out** to the firm for conversations if you aren't able to find a slot. Don't stress out about this!

What does good look like?

Starring Ashley and Aman

How some coffee chats might look

Starring Ashley and Aman

How do you think they did?

- **Make a connection beyond professional**
 - Develop rapport someway/somehow - these firm representatives are often recent Ross or B-school grads who were in your shoes a year or two ago!
- **Make your intro concise and compelling**
 - Be ready to double-click into details if the interviewer asks. Don't give a detailed 3-min intro when the firm rep only spent 15 seconds on theirs - look at the intro length of the firm rep for cues
- **Firm reps may have questions, or they may expect you to lead**
 - 'Tell me about yourself', 'Why this city?' tend to be the most common questions, but also be prepared for them to just expect you to ask questions
 - Structure your answers (without being a total robot) and have something compelling that's at least somewhat individual to your story
- **Awkward silence are inevitable**
 - You can avoid them by preparing your questions to lead with and "reading the room"
- **Do your research and have questions ready**
 - Do your firm research (and potentially look up your interviewer if possible, but don't be creepy about it!), showcase your passions in the Qs you ask - but be aware of the risks of "standing out"!
- **Be prepared for any logistical changes**
 - The person you're speaking with could be running late, finishing up a chat with someone else, or cancel at the last minute for other reasons. Be prepared to be flexible with any changes.

What does not work well:

- Awkward silences on unfamiliar topics
- Jumping into the discussion without establishing rapport
- Not reading the room
 - Asking multiple questions in a group coffee chat when everyone has not spoken yet
 - Asking for a firm referral if the chat has not gone well
- Treating the coffee chat as a tick-mark exercise

What can work well:

- Lean into your unique background and experience
 - Aman included a reference to growing up in a big family and his grandfather's influence in his "Tell Me About Yourself" story
- Ask questions if you are not familiar with a topic
 - e.g., Are you a big college football fan?
- Express gratitude if you receive help or support
- Treat coffee chats as a 2-way street: Firms are also looking to build a connection with you, so communicate with them!

...don't let this be you!



Thank You Examples

Hi XXX,

Thank you so much for taking the time to talk with me about your BCG Chicago experience the other day. I really enjoyed hearing about your path to BCG from Ross and your experience working on healthcare projects, especially working on some of the patient-facing applications. It's great to hear that you've found such interesting projects and a strong Ross community in Chicago.

If you could connect me with the colleague you mentioned who also transitioned from economic consulting, I'd really appreciate it.

Have a great weekend and Go Blue,
Louisa

Note – this is an example. Always customize your note based on your conversations and highlight key topics of conversation

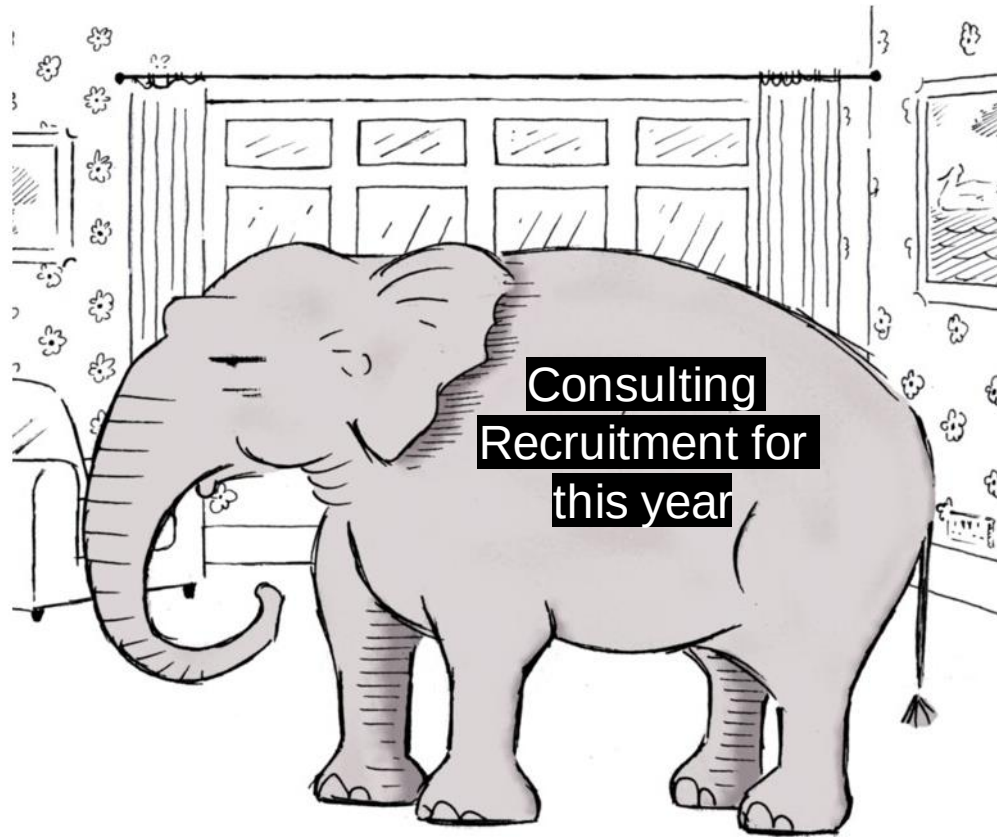
What can you be doing now?

Next steps and considerations

Now that we got that out of the way, here is what you can be doing in September

- Continue to perform **research on different career paths** by meeting with CDO coaches, talking to MBA2s, reading CDO on-line resources, etc.
- **Hone your resume on iMPact to reflect your Plan A.** – start early, and get multiple reviews in
- Get your final resume reviewed by CDO coach Randy Albert
- **Review the CDO Calendar of Events** and Recruiting Database to find out when companies of interest are coming on campus. Put these dates/times into your Google Calendar
- Keep **reading business-focused newspapers and magazines** (WSJ, Economist etc.) and try and understand the articles and create broad industry knowledge
- Use **classes as interview prep** and get used to justifying your statements in class. Professors are a lot less intimidating than Partners
- Get started on or continue **Crafting Cases** (& Bulletproof Math) to begin your case interview preparation
- Optional: If you know mental math will be a challenge for casing, **start using Management Consulted and other tools now**
- ✗ **DO NOT start contacting firms!** Contacting them now does little good for you, and if done improperly, will hurt you. Wait until recruiting starts and you have a reason to contact them.
- ✗ **DO NOT start full casing.** There is plenty of time to prepare in Fall B and you will burn yourself out if you start too early on full cases.
- ✗ **DO NOT attend “MBA2 only” or “Full-time only” recruiting events!!**

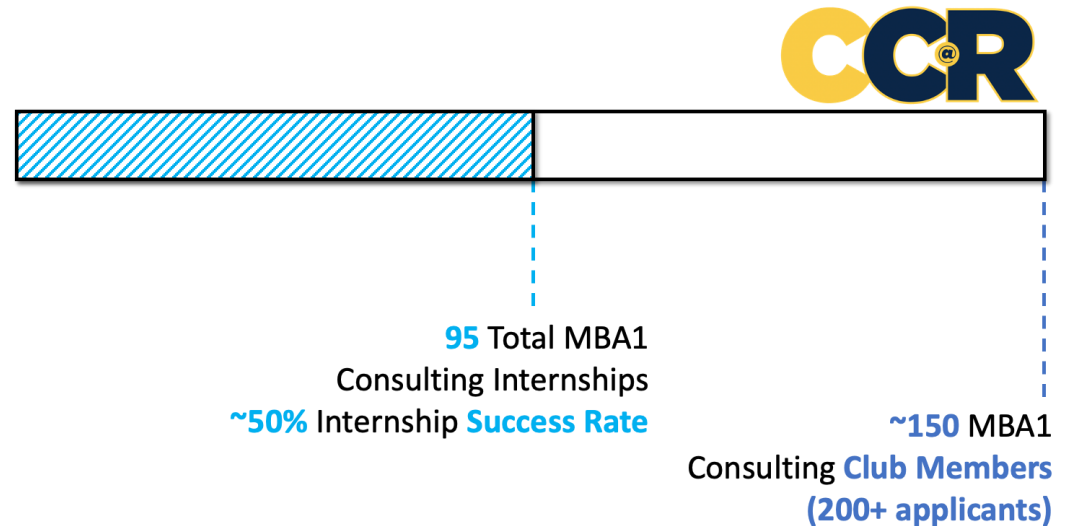
But before that, let's address...



"Just pretend I'm not here..."

What's consulting recruitment going to look like?

Consulting recruitment will not be simple, stay focused on the process



The facts:

- Not everyone is going to get a consulting internship, specifically at their #1 firm
- While macro situation seems tough, firms have told Ross they have no plans to alter internship recruiting
- There is a chance that you do not love your consulting internship

Here is what we recommend:

- Commit yourself the process
- Run your own race
- Make smart decisions, including applying to a diverse set of firms and having a meaningful plan B

Recruiting for Consulting ≠ Recruiting for MBB

- It's important to show consistent interest throughout the recruiting process in all firms you'd like to interview for
- Firms take your level of engagement and interest into consideration, too
- Doing the kind of work you want to do is FAR more important for exit opportunities than MBA-driven sense of prestige

Not all of you will get a job in consulting, it is very important that you have a Plan B. Having a Plan B that you are excited about will make this a lot less nerve racking and can therefore take some of the pressure off of the process.*

- ✓ Reach out to MBA2s that had jobs you are interested in ([Link to MBA Employment Data](#))
- ✓ Attend events for other industries
- ✓ Do research!

*A compelling Plan B helps you recruit for consulting by:

- Subconsciously presenting yourself more confidently to the consulting firms
- Mitigating feelings of desperation during consulting interviews

Recruiting for Investment Banking is NOT a feasible parallel path

- Consulting and Investment Banking recruiting take place around the same time and both require A LOT of your time
- Spreading yourself across these two paths will likely burn you out with less return than if you were to recruit one of these paths

Recruiting for Technology or General Management and Consulting is a bit more manageable

- Technology recruiting tends to happen at the same time or slightly later than consulting recruiting, and you will have practice with casing if tech interviews require it
- Tech recruiting can happen off campus too, which makes it easier for you to tackle both paths
- Do attend Education sessions for your Plan B as well!

How should you contact the CC@R Ed Team?

We will hang around after each Ed Session to answer immediate questions

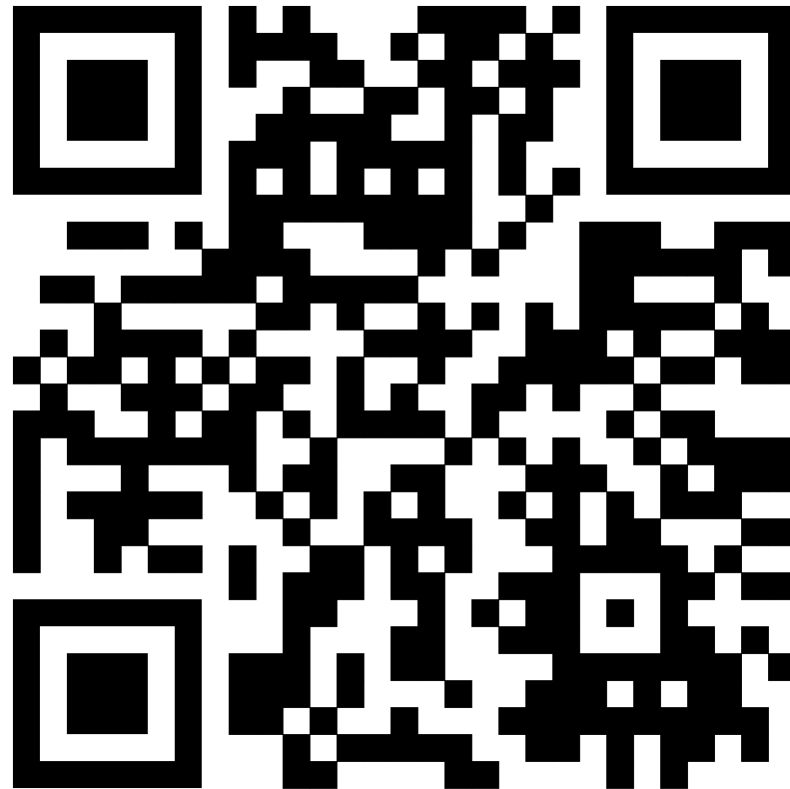
- **Smarak** is available on RossRecruit but very responsive on email if urgent
- **Ashley** is available on RossRecruit but is addicted to the dopamine rush of answering notifications, so email if urgent (but no guarantees)
- **Aman** is available on RossRecruit, but responsive on email (not on game days!)
- **Morgan** is not a peer coach but feel free to reach out via email if you have specific questions

Please keep your calendar up to date so we can follow up if needed

**We will be reviewing how to craft
your story via your resume, odyssey
and how to network**

Questions

Complete Feedback Form!



We actually read this feedback and are truly willing to make adjustments as needed. We want to make this the best experience for you that we can!

- Randy's emails – things to focus on this week, tips, and morale boosters
- Networking / Behavioral Interviews:
 - Syllabus book (Google Drive)
 - CDO website
- Case interviews (we're not there yet!):
 - Case books (Google Drive)
 - FACT group sessions
 - [Consulting page of CDO website](#)
 - Crafting Cases
 - Management Consulted